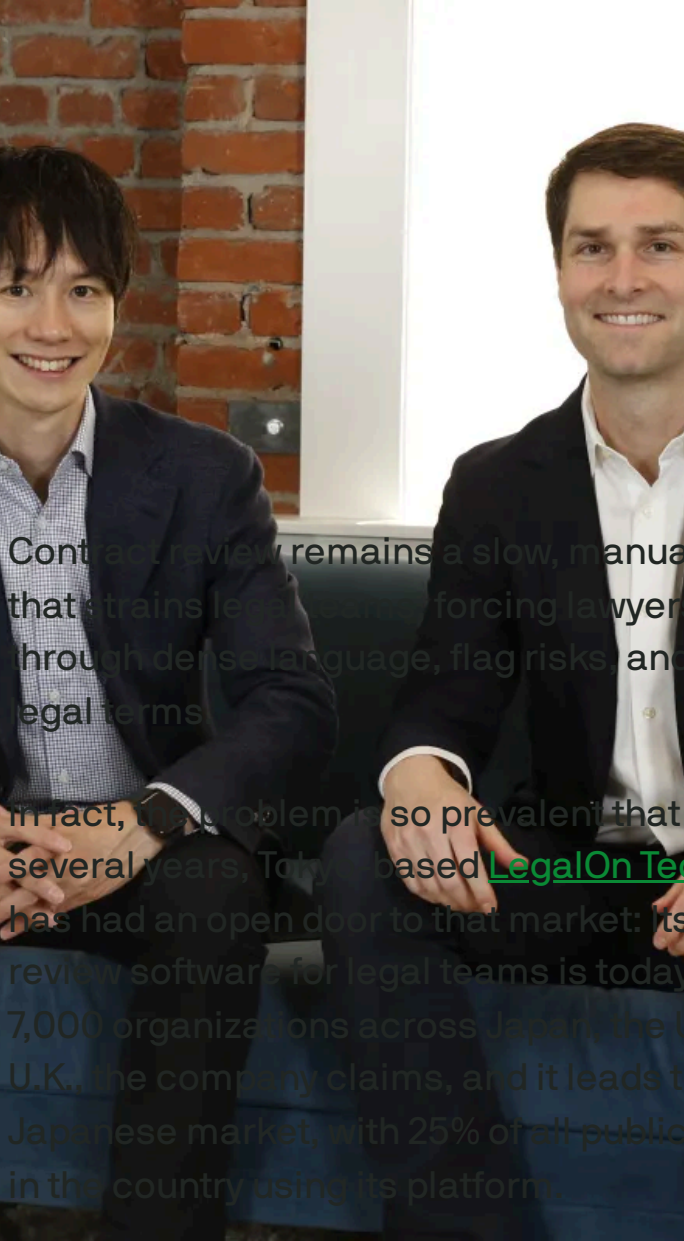


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FUNDRAISING



**SoftBank-backed
LegalOn lands \$50M to
streamline legal
workflows with AI**



Kate Park — 6:00 AM PDT · July 24, 2025

Contract review remains a slow, manual process that strains legal teams, forcing lawyers to sift through dense language, flag risks, and translate legal terms.

In fact, the problem is so prevalent that for the past several years, Tokyo-based [LegalOn Technologies](#) has had an open door to that market: Its AI contract review software for legal teams is today used by 7,000 organizations across Japan, the U.S., and the U.K., the company claims, and it leads the Japanese market, with 25% of all public companies in the country using its platform.

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IMAGE CREDITS: LEGALON TECHNOLOGIES



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LegalOn's AI contract review tool, [Review](#), identifies risks and suggests edits based on playbooks built by lawyers, and each customer's legal standards. The company claims Review cuts review times by up to 85% while improving quality and accuracy.

Success hasn't tempered LegalOn's ambitions, however. The company now wants to further build out AI agent tools to go along with its software, and recently raised \$50 million to do just that.

The Series E funding round is being led by Goldman Sachs' growth equity fund, and saw participation

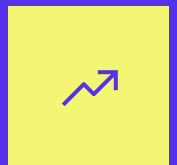
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from existing investor World Innovation Lab (WiL). New investors Mori Hamada & Matsumoto (a law firm in Japan), Mizuho Bank, and Shoko Chukin Bank also invested.

While a lot of the new cash is being dedicated to developing more AI agent products, the company is also enhancing its go-to-market efforts in the U.S. and U.K., where it says its business has quadrupled over the past year.

LegalOn declined to disclose its valuation.

TC

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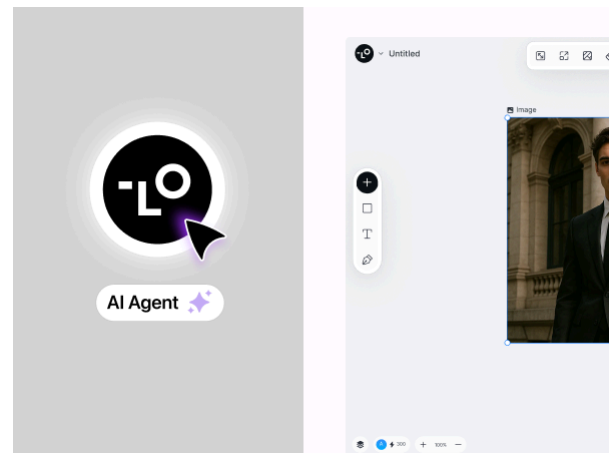
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Founded by two former corporate lawyers, Nozomu Tsunoda and Masataka Ogasawara in 2017, LegalOn aims to address time-consuming tasks before and after the contract review process, such as organizing legal requests and automating contract management.

According to Daniel Lewis, Global CEO of LegalOn, the company stands out from the hordes of legal tech startups using AI thanks to its foundation in

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps

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attorney-drafted, expert legal content. That base, he says, makes LegalOn unlike other tools that rely on users to build rules from scratch, or use generic AI models that lack the precision required for legal work.

“Our approach ensures contract reviews are aligned with real legal standards, making the output more accurate, consistent, and practical for legal teams. In addition, we have more than 50 attorney-built playbooks, seamless integration into existing workflows, and our solution works out-of-the-box on day one,” Lewis said.

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Just last week, the startup launched another tool: [Matter Management](#) helps legal teams track contract requests, assign owners, connect matters to relevant people and documents, and collaborate with other departments.

The company has also struck a non-equity tech partnership with OpenAI, which gives LegalOn access to the ChatGPT maker’s advanced large language models.

“It’s a technical collaboration,” Lewis explained. “It gives us early access to their latest models, and it positions our engineers to work kind of side-by-side with engineers from OpenAI. So in that regard, it will advance our goal of building cutting-edge [AI] agents using great technology, but being able to ground that in our proprietary legal content and expertise.”

The AI revolution is proving to be a massive tailwind for legal tech startups worldwide. In June, [Harvey AI secured \\$300 million in Series E funding](#), pushing

its valuation to \$5 billion, and last year, [Clio also raised \\$300 million, reaching a \\$3 billion valuation.](#)

But even as generative AI transforms the legal industry, Lewis doesn't think it will replace lawyers. "The state of the technology isn't there yet, and replacing lawyers isn't even our vision," he said. "Lawyers are still in the driver's seat. The things AI can't do perfectly today are, by definition, the things only people can do. And the lawyers who lean into that responsibility — to oversee, to edit, to exercise judgment — are the ones seeing the most extraordinary leverage from AI right now."

The Series E brings LegalOn's total capital raised to over \$200 million. Its investors include SoftBank Vision Fund, HSG (formerly known as Sequoia Capital China), Japanese venture capital firm JAFCO, and MUFG Bank.

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Kate Park

Reporter, Asia |

Kate Park is a reporter at TechCrunch, with a focus on technology, startups and venture capital in Asia. She...

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Cognitiv+ is using AI for contract analysis and tracking

Natasha Lomas — 4:36 AM PST · March 8, 2017

Another [legal tech startup](#) coming out of the UK: [Cognitiv+](#) is applying artificial intelligence to automate contract analysis and management, offering businesses a way to automate staying on top of legal risks, obligations and changing regulatory landscapes.

Co-founder Vasilis Tsoilis might therefore be forgiven for viewing [Brexit](#) as a sizable opportunity for his startup — though he more tactfully describes it as a “legislative challenge that we can help out with”.

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“There’s going to be a lot of changes in legislation, there’s going to be a lot of changes in regulation, and you really need to know what’s going to happen to your contracts and if you need to do any changes on your legal documents or not. So it’s going to be a huge challenge,” he says of Brexit.

“I think this is going to happen more and more often,” he adds, pointing to another incoming EU regulation that will be upping businesses’ compliance needs in the near future: aka the [GDPR](#), coming into force ([including in the UK](#)) in May 2018.

“Because you see legislation changing so fast and it’s getting so much bigger that actually it’s impossible to monitor and impossible to read it. Who can read half million of pages?”

“This is about day-to-day contract management but we think that compliance is going to be more and more strict, and it’s going to be much more difficult — there are so many new regulations, about Slavery Act, about GDPR, MiFid II and so many other compliances that all this accumulated risk analysis from your contracts we think it’s not possible to be viable for humans anymore — you need to bring the robots,” he adds.

Cognitiv+’s data-parsing tool is not being designed

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The overarching thesis is that contract analysis space/legal process outsourcing has yet to be disrupted by technology. Tsolis has both an engineering and a legal background, as you'd hope give the nature of the startup. Other co-founder, Achilleas Michos', background is in computer science.

"When you do contract analysis and compliance and when you do regulatory analysis there's a lot of repetition, and the majority of the people spend a lot of time — perhaps the majority of the time — looking for basic stuff... Legal but also admin assignments. So the majority of those tasks can be accelerated by automation," argues Tsolis.

Cognitiv+ is using what he describes as "a number of AI technologies" to perform the contract analysis at near real-time speeds, leaning on open source algorithms for the core tech. But he describes the IP as "the process and all the stages we take for analyzing a contract, the training" — so, in other words, the legal expertise needed to get a proper handle on compliance.

"We use machine learning, we use NLP [natural language processing], we use neural networks... We aim to be a risk management tool; we identify as much as possible that the machine can do," he tells TechCrunch. "When it comes to [analyzing an

area such as] limit of liability if the contract is not very well drafted then obviously we cannot help you on this one — but we can help you for the vast majority of the contracts that you have on your library.”

Presumably the tech might also be able to flag up a badly drafted contract.

Contracts are uploaded to the system for analysis and tracking, with examples of the sorts of critical information Cognitiv+ can extract including the parties of the contract; the limit of liability; renewal and termination information; and jurisdiction.

Users are delivered intel on an ongoing basis via reports, dashboards and notifications. The tool is generally being designed for use by in-house lawyers, commercial staff, procurement, financial and compliance departments.

The current industry focus for the team is procurement in the financial sector, but next year it plans to expand to target the insurance, real estate and engineering industries too. They’re currently also only tracking UK-related compliance, but are intending to add EU and US in the “coming months”.

Given the financial services focus, they’re also looking at how the tech could be used to help combat financial crime, according to Tsolis.

The early stage startup has been bootstrapping since being founded in late 2015, and has just gone through London’s [Winton Labs](#) accelerator for data-focused businesses. It’s also in the midst of closing a seed round, and is running pilots of v1 of its contract-parsing platform with a “small number” of UK companies.

Tsolis says the first version is a fairly generic analytical tool, but a more vertical-specific v2 is coming in September — for financial and procurement users — and another version planned for March 2018 will target the other three target sectors. The aim is to begin revenue generating this year, via a SaaS business model.

Could the tech also be applied for drafting contracts in future, not just analyzing them? UK startup [Juro](#), for example, already offers both contract authoring and management, though it looks to have a bit of a different focus (on marketplaces and sales contracts).

“The legal world is a long lived world for centuries now, and it’s a very traditional sector. And actually I think you need to disrupt it step by step,” says Tsolis, emphasizing the need to “bring together all the stakeholders” to ensure buy-in.

“It’s not just the lawyers — a lot of people read contracts, like the financial people, commercial, procurement, compliance, so you need to bring all the stakeholders together to ensure that people understand what the machine does. And move on to new ways of interacting with the machine and NLP and new technologies.”

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Natasha was a senior reporter for TechCrunch, from September 2012 to April 2025, based in Europe. She joine...

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AI



Solve Intelligence helps attorneys draft patents for IP analysis and generation

Kate Park — 4:58 AM PST · November 28, 2023

IMAGE CREDITS: MATHISWORKS / GETTY IMAGES

Many legal tech startups streamline manual workflow for lawyers, and some legal tech companies provide tech solutions centered around intellectual property (IP). Among them is a startup called [Solve Intelligence](#), which builds AI software specialized for patent attorneys to write drafts for IP analysis and generation.

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Solve Intelligence, a Delaware-based legal tech startup, has raised \$3 million in funding from investors, including Y Combinator, Amino Capital, General Advance, SAV, Translink Capital and Nomad Capital.

Chief research officer of Solve Sanj Ahilan and CEO of Solve Chris Parsonson both completed PhDs in artificial intelligence at University College London and experienced the time and cost difficulties of getting a patent while working at tech companies such as Huawei and Dyson. Chris also heard from his patent attorney girlfriend that there's a lack of software available for patent attorneys beyond Microsoft Word.

Ahilan, Parsonson and Angus Parsonson (chief technology officer of Solve Intelligence) founded Solve Intelligence in June 2023 and launched its product in July.

"Patents are fundamentally different from other areas of legal tech because they intersect both technology and patent law," Chris Parsonson said, adding that drafting a patent requires combining deep technical addition to legal expertise.

"Unlike other legal professionals, many patent attorneys never go to court or review contracts. Instead, they first gain deep technical expertise in a **STEM** field through an undergraduate, master's and often a PhD program," the CEO continued. "They train for years to pass the bar, after which they can become fully qualified patent attorneys. As such, the algorithms and AI systems needed to write and review patents differ from those needed for equivalent tasks in other areas of legal tech."

Solve's product, an in-browser document editor that works like Google Docs but under the hood, is powered by an AI copilot to help attorneys with intellectual property generation. Its AI solution can

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identify novelty and non-obviousness and help the R&D process. Each approved patent defines what is “novel” and “non-obvious” about a new technology over all other technologies in the public domain, Parsonson said.



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“Our AI will be able to automatically pick out the most promising novel and non-obvious steps, rank them by commercial viability, and send these over to the IP firm working with the tech company to begin drafting the patent,” Parsonson said, adding that the AI product helps with patent portfolio infringement litigation after the patent is drafted.

The startup has over 25 IP firms across the U.S., Europe, Asia and South America using its product. Solve claims many of them report 60-90% efficiency improvements. The outlet, which is in the early stage, is already generating recurring revenue between around \$100,000 and \$1 million by selling its product on a per-seat subscription basis.

The patent analytics market [is projected to increase](#) by \$5.18 billion in 2032, up from \$1.3 billion in 2022.



IMAGE CREDITS: SOLVE_INTELLIGENCE FOUNDERS

Some potential user attorneys don't want to use the AI product due to confidentiality concerns on generative AI tools like ChatGPT. Undisclosed inventions are highly confidential since they haven't yet been patented.

"Attorneys who turn us down due to confidentiality concerns generally do not yet understand the difference between large language model training and inference. We believe this will be temporary and will become less of a problem over time as people gain [a] greater understanding of AI," Parsonson said. "Everything is encrypted both in transit and storage and is stored on enterprise AWS servers, so our customers get all of the state-of-the-art security assurances that come with enterprise AWS servers. Hosting AWS is likely much more secure than many alternative custom hosting solutions, which is one of the reasons cloud computing has become so popular over the last decade."

Solve says it does not train on clients' data but uses several "proprietary models, algorithms, sequential

LLM calls and [retrieval augmented generation](#) (RAG) approaches which have been specialized for patent drafting and more generally for IP analysis and generation.” The startup is getting patents for many of these methods and working with some of its IP firm clients to write these patents with the help of its own AI product.

The startup believes every legal professional will use AI daily within the next five years. “The winners will be those who rapidly iterate their product to something genuinely helpful for legal professionals. That’s why we’ve formed a lean, highly technical team of AI PhDs and software dev experts capable of building the features our users want faster than our competitors,” the CEO said.

Some companies develop software for IP, like [PatSnap](#), CIPHER and [IPRally](#), which focus on prior art search and technology classification and clustering for R&D teams. Other legal tech companies, including [Harvey AI](#), [Robin AI](#) and [Casetext](#), build software for legal professionals to draft legal contracts and find and incorporate relevant case law, but they do not focus on patents. What Solve zeroes in on is generative tasks (on patents) like drafting and responding to office actions, Parsonson pointed out.

“There are many exciting areas our product will be able to help across the intellectual property lifecycle. Patent drafting is just at the beginning,” Parsonson said.

Solve will use the funding to hire staff, meet the demand of new customers and scale R&D for its next generation of patent drafting features, which it will release over the next couple of months, including “algorithms and processes for using AI to generate and analyze technical drawings, review patents to increase their quality, customize the AI to

draft in the unique style of the attorney, and much more.”

Legal tech startups bringing law, order to fragmented industry



A number of legal tech startups are eager to not only help lawyers, but automate some of the processes bogged down by pen and paper.



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Kate Park is a reporter at TechCrunch, with a focus on technology, startups and venture capital in Asia. She...

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